STATUS REPORT

Tunisia — digital transformation and data governance status report

Edition of 2026-08-18 · compiled from the Data Landscapers source base

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

The Medusa submarine cable's France–Tunisia route entered service on 3 June 2026, seven months after the system came ashore at Bizerte on 31 October 2025, its first landing point on the African continent.

The landing is Orange's: Orange Tunisia owns and operates the Bizerte station and the roughly 1,050 km Tunisian segment, built as the ViaTunisia project on an open-access model, and has since brought the capacity into commercial service against a design maximum of 24 Tbps (November 2025). Tunisie Telecom is a customer rather than an owner, having agreed in February 2025 to take a dedicated Bizerte–Marseille fibre pair carrying 20 Tbps. The incumbent, 65 per cent state-owned and 35 per cent held by Emirates International Telecommunications (July 2024), is running an EBRD-financed programme of household fibre, backbone upgrading and migration from 3G to 4G and 5G.

All three operators launched commercial 5G within days of each other in February 2025, under 15-year licences awarded in November 2024 giving each 5 MHz at 700 MHz and 100 MHz of TDD spectrum at 3.5 GHz; Orange opened with 400 sites live and Ooredoo built its offer around fixed-wireless access at up to 100 Mbps, a home-broadband substitute. 4G covered 96 per cent of the population (2024), a data-only mobile broadband basket costs about 1.5 per cent of gross national income per head (2024) — inside the ITU's affordable band — and mobile broadband is now the dominant means of access, with voice flat (2025).

Most Tunisians are online, though use is concentrated in the coastal belt of Tunis, Sfax and Sousse (2024), and the headline mobile penetration figure of over 100 per cent counts SIM cards rather than people. The measured gain is real — the Internet & Computers score rose 38.1 points over 2014-2023 to 76.9 of 100, 4th of 54 African states and the second most improved of the index's 96 indicators — but over the same decade public perception of infrastructure fell 13.2 points to 34.3 of 100, 23rd of 54. Domestic interconnection remains thin, with one active exchange point, TunIXP, carrying four peering participants (2026).

Data Storage

Tunisian public bodies have been required since Circular 16 of 22 July 2024 to host confidential or sensitive data on Tunisian soil, with providers certified under the National Cybersecurity Agency's N-Cloud and G-Cloud schemes — a residency duty on the public sector rather than a general personal-data localisation law, and one that is reaching procurement: the Societe Tunisienne de Banque's 2025 hosting tender requires data held in Tunisia with an N-Cloud certified provider.

What that data sits on is state-run and basic. The National Centre for Informatics operates the government hosting service and the national data-centre capacity public bodies' systems run on (2026), and the government cloud is a government-operated private cloud offering infrastructure as a service (2025). Its usage, security and savings are neither monitored nor published (2025).

Commercially there is more than there was: Orange Tunisia has inaugurated a facility outside Sousse, alongside ATLAX and Dataxion sites in Tunis (2026). But no hyperscale cloud provider operates a region in the country (2025), so Tunisian users of the major public clouds are served from Europe.

The ambition is now statutory and unfunded. Data centres appear as a named project line in Volume II of the Plan de développement 2026-2030, the annex approved by loi n° 2026-16 of 20 July 2026 and so the binding reference for public policy to 2030 — but with no budget line, no sequencing and no delivery agency attached (June 2026). The Tunisia Investment Authority had already named data centres one of two core priorities of investment strategy at its 22nd Strategic Council (October 2025), recommending a dedicated cloud and data-centre special economic zone through public-private partnerships and renewable generation to power it, and its monitoring work found investors want demand, transparent regulation, reliable connectivity and data-residency compliance before committing, with data-protection reform on the same list. One private project has been announced: an Anglo-Tunisian company plans a solar-powered data centre at Bizerte, a site that is the landing point of three subsea cables including Medusa (February 2026), under a non-binding memorandum with Schneider Electric. None of it is built.

Energy

Renewables supplied about 4 per cent of Tunisia's electricity generation in 2025, down from 4.4 per cent in 2024, with natural gas at 95 to 96 per cent, even though installed renewable capacity has reached roughly 1.21 GW. A digital estate plugged into this grid runs on gas, and the share is moving the wrong way.

The grid itself is not the constraint. Electricity reaches effectively the whole population, at 100 per cent access with no material urban-rural gap (2023), a position the Ibrahim index scores at 99.9 of 100, 3rd of 54 African states (2023), and firms report 0.4 outages a month, around five a year (2024) — among the steadiest supply on the continent, and the one input a data-centre investor would not have to price around. Distributed supply is enabled rather than left to the market: the national energy agency deploys photovoltaic systems for isolated sites and households under the PROSOL Elec programme.

Powering digital infrastructure from renewables is so far intention rather than generation. The Tunisia Investment Authority's data-centre recommendations include expanding renewable generation to power the facilities (October 2025); the announced Bizerte data centre is to draw on a 60 MW solar site at Tozeur whose base camp became operational in November 2025, which is at an early stage of construction; and the incumbent operator's modernisation programme carries energy-efficiency and solar investment alongside its network build.

Technical Capacity

Government's own digital-skills effort for the public service reaches only basic skills (2025), which is a thin foundation for an administration that builds its own software. The wider base is stronger than that suggests: Tunisia has an identifiable community of public open-source contributors (2022), and one of the world's highest shares of tertiary graduates in STEM subjects, fed by established engineering and ICT institutions. What is less certain is the administration's ability to absorb it, with measured effectiveness sitting mid-table among African states (2023) despite a high overall governance rank.

Every one of the seven core government systems assessed in 2025 — financial management, debt management, customs, tax, HR, payroll and social insurance — runs on custom-built software rather than commercial or open-source packages, a pattern that implies in-house build capacity and commits the state to maintaining all of it itself.

Cybersecurity

No operational governance for compliance, security and audit trails is recorded for Tunisia's tax management information system, its financial management information system or its treasury single account (2025) — the three systems that handle public money, and the gap sits against a country the ITU scores at 81.93 on its Global Cybersecurity Index, in the top Role-Modelling tier (2024). The index measures institutional commitment, and Tunisia's is genuine on paper.

The instruments are in place. Decree-Law 2023-17 of 11 March 2023 requires organisations within its scope to undergo periodic technical audits reported to the National Cybersecurity Agency and to notify it of cyberattacks, with financial penalties for failure; the National Cyberspace Strategy runs from 2020 to 2025; and the cybercrime framework, Decree-Law 54 of 2022, mixes computer-crime provisions with offences covering content carried over communications networks. In payments, operators of settlement systems must run an annual information-systems security audit reported to the Central Bank, a duty licensed payment institutions have carried since 2018.

What almost none of that assurance is, is public. Governance for customs, HR, payroll and e-procurement systems is established but kept internal and unpublished (2025); the cybersecurity audit of the Sahetna.tn health portal was completed and reviewed at a steering committee on 10 June 2026 without being released; and security reviews of the E-Houwiya digital identity are not in the public domain. The forward plan gives the subject little weight, with cybersecurity mentioned a fraction as often as digitalisation and artificial intelligence in the 2026-2030 development plan.

Against citizens the exposure is ordinary and current. The national agency warned on 30 July 2026 of an SMS phishing campaign sent from foreign numbers using fake unpaid-traffic-fine notices, linking to counterfeit platforms built to harvest banking and personal data, impersonating a state payment channel; its answer was advice to distrust unsolicited links and to check that a site sits on the .tn domain that government websites use, a naming convention rather than a control.

DPI

Data Exchange

The first production data-exchange services between Tunisian agencies reached service in 2025, and there are two of them: a death-notification service supplied by the civil registry to the Ministry of Social Affairs, and a tax-status lookup supplied by the Finance Ministry's tax IT centre to another public body, both running on the interoperability platform operated by the National Centre for Informatics.

The layer underneath is the Unified eXchange Platform, an X-Road-derived interoperability platform supplied by Estonia's Cybernetica with EBRD and Swiss SECO funding, whose first phase onboarded five institutions — the interior, education, transport and social affairs ministries and their agencies. The government reported that phase delivered by the end of 2025, and has published a phased roadmap with large-scale deployment across government as the next stage. A second phase contracted in May 2026 and due to complete in 2027 extends the exchange to six business-environment bodies — the national enterprise register, the investment authority, the industry agency APII, the export centre CEPEX, the Ministry of Finance and the Central Bank, adding high-availability modules and naming a higher UN e-government ranking as an objective.

Every participant so far is a central-government body, and municipalities and other sub-national bodies are not connected. Health data exchange runs through the CNAM health insurance fund's own systems rather than the national platform, and neither the electoral register nor the justice sector appears in either phase. The business register exchanges data instead through bespoke know-your-customer and beneficial-ownership web-service contracts made under a 2020 interoperability decree. Core government systems — financial management, tax, customs, HR, payroll, social insurance and e-procurement — exchange data through a Government Service Bus and through point-to-point interfaces alongside it, and the World Bank's 2025 assessment records a government interoperability framework in place and extensively used. The most consequential join key is being built outside all of this: the national health identifier is bound to the national identity card, the social security number and school and university identifiers. What crosses is legally constrained: the data protection authority must authorise sharing, and transfer abroad is prohibited without authorisation.

Digital Identity and CRVS

Tunisia legislated a biometric national identity card in March 2024 and had issued none by December 2025, when the interior ministry's account of the programme carried no implementation date, no issuance start, no supplier and no enrolment figure. Organic Law 2024-22 of 11 March 2024 creates a card with an electronic chip holding fingerprints, gives the holder access to the encrypted chip data with an audit trail of every access, and lowers the age at which the card is compulsory from 18 to 15. This is a new credential rather than a digitisation of an old one: the existing card carries only an inked thumbprint image printed on the back and no electronic biometric template.

The mobile credential works. E-Houwiya has been operational nationwide since August 2022 and is legally equivalent to face-to-face identification, but holding it carries no obligation; it carries a personal X.509 certificate and a qualified digital signature equivalent to a handwritten one, and is free. Around 200,000 people held one as at March 2025. It is single sign-on across the e-Bawaba government portal and the health insurance, social security and school platforms, and is becoming compulsory in slices: the investment authority has required it for investment-project declarations since 1 July 2026, and the business register requires one for access to its digital services.

Behind both sits the unique citizen identifier register created by Decree-Law 2020-17 of 12 May 2020, assigning every Tunisian an eleven-digit lifetime identifier, holding roughly 15 million records and restricted by law to Tunisian nationals, with no provision for foreign residents or refugees. It deduplicates on demographic data alone and holds no biometric template. The identifier is assigned at birth registration, and a birth certificate is required for the card — and in rural civil status offices births, deaths and marriages are still written by hand into duplicate paper registers which hold sole legal probative force, transcribed afterwards into the national digital system. Public perception of how easily an identity document can be obtained fell 41.9 points over 2014-2023 to 55.1 of 100, the seventh most deteriorated of the Ibrahim Index's 96 indicators.

Digital Payments and Fintech

The Central Bank of Tunisia and the national electronic payments operator Société Monétique Tunisie launched TUNPAY in May 2026, a national mobile payments label which banks, payment institutions and the postal service must integrate into their wallets, interfaces and acceptance points.

It is a label on a thin base. A domestic instant mobile money system has run under Central Bank governance since 2018 and is deployed nationwide, but fewer than a million wallets were active in 2025 and the market is still dominated by transfers between individuals rather than retail payment. Access to banking services scored 22.5 of 100 in 2023, 19th of 54 African states and among Tunisia's ten worst-scoring Ibrahim Index indicators despite a 5.8-point rise over the decade. Ooredoo Fintech obtained a Central Bank licence in March 2026 for the walletii wallet.

Cross-border digital payment has not started. The Central Bank joined the Pan-African Payment and Settlement System in February 2024, with commercial banks still being urged to onboard a year later, and as at June 2026 none was participating, leaving the scheme unavailable to customers.

Government is the heavier user. The IFC and the Central Bank launched Paysmart in 2022 for electronic payment of utility and other public bills, remote payment of the vehicle tax and an electronic fiscal stamp were both in service by the end of 2025, and 44.4 per cent of Amen Social cash transfers are paid digitally through cards linked to electronic wallets provided with Tunisian Post, the rest in cash.

The rules concentrate in one institution: the Central Bank owns, operates and supervises the Elyssa real-time gross settlement system and the SGMT settlement system under Law 2016-35, acting as owner, supervisor, manager and an ordinary participant at once, though it publishes the Elyssa operating rules. Law 2005-51 of 2005 sets payment-specific consumer protection duties, and Circular 2024-005 requires system operators to run a board-level audit and risk committee and an annual security audit. There are no payment-specific data protection provisions; transaction data is governed only by the general 2004 personal data law. The National Financial Inclusion Strategy ran to 2022.

Registries

Tunisia is rebuilding its land register from the ground up: a $50 million three-year contract was signed in May 2025 with a South Korean consortium led by Samsung C&T to digitise the cadastre office's archives and build an integrated land information system. There is no address register to join it to: the postal service operates only a locality-level four-digit postcode system in place since 1980, and the cadastre records parcels rather than street names and building numbers.

The business register is the furthest ahead. The Registre National des Entreprises is fully digital and deployed nationwide, with online registration and a public search portal, holds about 800,000 companies (2024), and went fully digital from 1 July 2026, discontinuing paper filing and putting company creation online end to end — with a February 2026 decree giving its electronic documents the same legal value as paper. It links outward by bilateral agreement, including a convention with the electoral commission ISIE in December 2024 to share data directly between the two registers.

Civil registration is complete but only half digitised. Birth registration has been recorded at or above 99 per cent consistently since 2001, across rural and urban areas and for both sexes, and registration is open to all foreigners whose civil status events occur in the country. Madania has run nationwide since April 2005, centralising civil registration from all 350 municipalities and issuing documents online regardless of where the event was registered, exchanging records electronically with the social security funds — but only births and deaths are systematically digitised, with marriage and divorce registrations legally required and never entered into the digital system.

The electoral roll is digital, managed by ISIE, with an online voter portal for registration checks and updates and about 9.75 million registered voters in a population of roughly 12 million (2024), though enrolment remains a separate, largely manual and voluntary process rather than an automated link to the identity card database it draws on. The social registry, Amen Social, is digital and nationwide, covering about 333,000 poor households and a further 620,000 low-income households (2023).

Sectoral management information systems

Medical files for roughly 100,000 people had been linked to Tunisia's national health identifier by 27 July 2026, on the back of a pilot running in university hospitals since June 2026, where it consolidates a patient's records across departments into one file. The identifier is assigned from the national identity card at registration, with nationwide rollout targeted by the end of 2026. It is not a new build — it is the EVAX code created for Covid-19 vaccination, repurposed, and already held records of over 3 million childhood immunisations (July 2026). Phase 1 of the digital hospital project was delivered by the end of 2025.

The tier below the hospitals is where it stops. Rural primary healthcare clinics record patient data on paper as the default at the point of care, and in February 2025 the health ministry described connecting front-line primary care facilities to the internet as a forthcoming phase rather than an achieved one. Schools show the same split — the national Tarbia.tn platform consolidates school services into a single portal for parents and teachers, while rural primary schools still capture data largely on paper.

The revenue and administration systems are the mature ones. The tax administration runs a nationwide digital register with online taxpayer identification and electronic declaration, processing more than 245 million dematerialised operations in 2024 across income and business taxes including VAT. Customs and tax management information systems both run on custom software, and the two administrations are not merged. The HR management information system is in use with a self-service portal on which most services are digitised, linked to a payroll system, and a social insurance and pension system covers non-health social insurance, with a separate system for public sector employees. Public financial management is the weak point: budgetary and financial management fell 27.7 points over 2014-2023 to 41.7 of 100, 43rd of 54 African states.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

Tunisia's e-government readiness stood at 0.6935 on the UN's 2024 index, in the Very High band and third in Africa, yet its main public service portal is informational rather than transactional: a citizen can find out about services there but cannot complete most of them. The sectoral portals are the ones that work: the tax portal supports registration, filing and payment, the social insurance and pension portal offers registration and benefits transactions, and the tax administration launched a platform in August 2026 for completing the patente business-registration procedure remotely and downloading the tax identification card. Take-up is the constraint: about a quarter of Tunisian internet users report using online public administration, the least used of the four activities the telecoms regulator's 2026 survey measured.

The state is legislating faster than it is building. Article 53 of the 2026 Finance Law generalised compulsory electronic invoicing to all service providers from 1 January 2026, and MPs moved within weeks to amend it, drawing the ministries and agencies that would have to operate such a system into joint committee hearings.

The financial core is in place but incomplete. A financial management information system covers central and local government budgets, debt management covers foreign and domestic debt, an e-procurement portal supports online tendering and contracting and interfaces with other systems, and a treasury single account settles through the real-time gross settlement system, though its interface to central bank systems is still being implemented. There is no public investment management system at all, and so no project database.

Coordination exists ahead of the strategy it serves. 192 digital-transformation projects are under national follow-up, monitored by a ministerial council chaired by Head of Government Sarra Zaafrani Zenzri, and a ministry leads transformation with a cross-government forum of senior digital officials, while the whole-of-government approach itself is still in draft. Almost none of it is visible from outside: no entity monitors digital and GovTech spending across government, neither the GovTech institution's annual progress report nor spending on the transformation is published, and nor is service delivery performance and user experience data for the public service portal.

Governance

Legislation and regulation

Parliament's live digital business is invoicing rather than identity: in February 2026 twelve MPs put bill 2026/012 before a joint session of the Finance and Budget committee and the Administration, Digitisation, Governance and Anti-Corruption committee, a single-article amendment reopening the compulsory electronic invoicing obligation that Article 53 of the 2026 Finance Law extended to all service providers from 1 January 2026. The amendment is in committee; the obligation it targets is in force. The year's other change came by decree: electronic documents issued by the National Business Register have carried the same legal value as their paper equivalents since 12 February 2026.

The binding stock underneath is old and narrow. The Electronic Exchanges and Electronic Commerce Act of 2000 remains the instrument giving legal effect to electronic signatures, electronic identification and online commerce. Identity and security have been legislated more recently — the decree-law of 12 May 2020 creating the unique citizen identifier register, the organic law of 11 March 2024 on the biometric identity card, the cybersecurity decree-law of 11 March 2023 and Decree-Law 54 of 2022, which pairs computer-crime provisions with offences covering content transmitted over communications networks. Electronic fund transfers are governed by a 2005 law and startups by the 2018 Startup Act. Paper keeps a statutory footing of its own: the Code of Criminal Procedure requires a physical register for custody entries.

Elsewhere policy stands in for statute, the general national digital strategy carrying ground that sector-specific law would otherwise hold, from broadband and payments to artificial intelligence. That is not being closed quickly: in April 2026 the communication-technologies minister was still pledging further legal and regulatory development on artificial intelligence and data protection. Data protection, treated below, rests on a 2004 statute with a replacement bill in committee, and challenges to the regulator run through the ordinary courts, there being no identity-specific judicial mechanism.

Strategies, plans and policies

Digital policy has changed owner. The digital-transformation vision is now carried as a chapter of the whole-of-government 2026-2030 Development Plan coordinated by the Ministry of Economy and Planning rather than as a sectoral ICT strategy, and the plan was approved by loi n° 2026-16 of 20 July 2026, which makes it a policy instrument carried by statute.

What the plan weights is legible from its own text. Volume II mentions digital or digitalisation 414 times, artificial intelligence 119 times and data 72 times, but cybersecurity only 9 (June 2026), and frames its digital chapter as integration into the global digital economy while preserving digital sovereignty. Alongside it, the National Digital Development Strategy adopted in 2021 is the single policy instrument covering artificial intelligence, broadband, broadcasting, cybersecurity, data centres and cloud services, data protection, digital identification, digital payments, digital signatures and e-commerce — one document doing the work of ten.

Machinery runs ahead of the strategy it serves. A GovTech and digital transformation strategy was current in 2025 while the whole-of-government approach behind it was still only planned or in draft, a lead ministry and a cross-government forum of senior digital officials already being in place. There is no data governance strategy or policy at all, and the body responsible for data governance publishes no progress report on its results or its spending (2025). Delivery is directed from the centre: the Head of Government instructed the administration in February 2026 to expand electronic payments, interlink citizen services and embed cybersecurity, artificial intelligence and open data across the digitalisation programme, with digital-transformation projects placed under national follow-up by a ministerial council.

The governing record behind the paper is deteriorating. Overall governance scored 61.2 of 100 in 2023, ninth of 54 African states, but had fallen 4.7 points over 2014-2023 and 5.6 points over the most recent five years; public administration fell 12.5 points to 60.2, sixteenth of 54; and across the index Tunisia improved on 41 of 96 indicators and declined on 52 (2023).

Regional collaboration

Tunisia was elected on 24 July 2026, at the African Telecommunications Union's plenipotentiary conference in Abuja, to a 2027-2030 seat on the union's administrative council, the body that sets continental direction on digital transformation, artificial intelligence, cybersecurity and capacity building.

Money crosses the border less readily than office. The central bank joined the Pan-African Payment and Settlement System in February 2024, and Tunisian commercial banks were still being urged to onboard a year later; the scheme lists Tunisia as coming live with no commercial bank participating (June 2026), so the route is not open to Tunisian customers.

Standards

The interoperability framework is used but unaudited: it is in place and extensively used across government, while its usage, compliance with it and the benefits from it are neither monitored nor published (2025). Nobody in government can say what the shared standard has bought.

The standards that are documented are mostly financial and procedural. A unified budget classification and chart of accounts covers both central and sub-national government (2025), e-procurement data is published in line with the Open Contracting Data Standard (2025), and a data quality framework, a system for monitoring the uptime of government information systems and formal guidance for replacing legacy systems are all recorded as in place (2025). Payments set their own: the central bank published the Elyssa settlement system's adhesion conditions and operating rules, and TUNPAY, a national mobile payments label that banks, payment institutions and the postal service must integrate, launched in May 2026. Security duties are mandated by the 2023 cybersecurity decree-law, which requires periodic technical audits reported to the National Cybersecurity Agency.

Where standards bite hardest is hosting. Public bodies must place confidential or sensitive data with providers certified under the National Cybersecurity Agency's N-Cloud and G-Cloud schemes on Tunisian soil, and a 2025 bank hosting tender carried the requirement into procurement. Procurement is not used to open the market in other ways: there is no policy prioritising bids from startups and smaller firms (2025), and no government open source software policy or action plan for the public sector exists at all (2025) — an unusual omission for a state that has built its interoperability layer on the X-Road lineage, extended under a Phase-2 contract in May 2026.

Data protection

A replacement for Tunisia's twenty-year-old data protection statute reached parliamentary committee in February 2026: a proposed organic law of 123 articles across six titles, running from processing principles and data-subject rights to the protection authority and penalties, was under review by the Assembly of People's Representatives' Rights and Freedoms Committee. A GDPR-aligned replacement has been in draft since 2018 and was still not enacted in early 2026. The bill would introduce a data protection officer role and oblige public institutions to obtain declarations or authorisations for any processing and shift enforcement towards financial penalties administered by a dedicated sanctions department inside the authority; its sponsors put the institutional gap it addresses at the limited role of the existing authority.

Until it passes, Organic Law 2004-63 of 27 July 2004 governs, giving rights of access, rectification and objection, requiring prior declaration or authorisation before processing, and carrying criminal sanctions for breach. The Instance Nationale de Protection des Données à Caractère Personnel is the oldest such body in Africa and the Arab world, authorising and registering processing declarations, handling complaints and issuing appealable decisions; its decisions go on appeal to the Court of Appeal of Tunis and then the Court of Cassation. Sharing from the identity systems needs the authority's authorisation, transfer abroad is prohibited without it, and chip access on the biometric card is confined to designated agents with an audit trail.

Little of that is visible. The authority's performance and results, and its complaints record, are held internally and not published (2025). New systems launch without naming it: on the linked national health dataset the health ministry said only that data is stored confidentially and securely, naming no legal basis and no role for the authority (27 July 2026), and July 2026's national register of community companies asserted secure personal-data storage with no legal basis named and no regulator identified. Parliament has noticed: its memo on the e-invoicing amendment states that mass electronic invoicing raises serious data-protection issues. Modernising the framework also sits on the Tunisia Investment Authority's list of changes needed to attract data-centre investment (October 2025).

Public debate and participation in policymaking

The participation platform does not carry participation: Tunisia runs a national citizen participation platform that also accepts petitions, but citizens and businesses cannot use it to take part in policy decision-making (2025). It takes no anonymous submissions, offers no omnichannel access, and government responses to citizens and businesses are not made public (2025).

Service feedback fares a little better on paper. Government platforms take complaints, suggestions and information requests, and the service standards that apply to them, including response times and procedures, are published (2025). But there is no record of government changing a service in response to that feedback, and the platforms support neither users with disabilities nor omnichannel access (2025). Design is closed too: citizens and businesses are not involved in designing the main public service portal, the tax online services or the job portal, and only the social insurance and pension portal involves its users (2025).

The wider space has narrowed sharply. Deliberative and participatory governance fell 16.8 points over 2014-2023 to 69.8 of 100, inside a participation sub-category that fell 34.7 points to 46.1 and now ranks 27th of 54 — the country's steepest decline on any measure in the index. Civil society space fell 30.7 points to 64.2 and media freedom 17.0 points to 54.3, twenty-eighth of 54 (2023). Online speech has a criminal frame around it: Decree-Law 54 of 2022 attaches offences to content transmitted over communications networks.

Records to argue with remain hard to get. Right-to-information legislation is in force and monitored, yet the count of requests received and granted is recorded internally and not published (2025), and disclosure of public records scored 32.3 of 100 in 2023 against an accessibility score of 59.6 — reachable in principle, withheld in practice.

Inclusion

Digital divides

Access to Public Services for Women in Tunisia stood at 57.8 of 100 in 2023, 13th of 54 African states and unchanged over the preceding decade — a flat line across the same ten years in which the country's internet and computer access improved faster than almost any other measure the index tracks. The broader reading of how far access varies between groups moved the wrong way: Equal Access to Public Services was 59.3 of 100 in 2023, 8th of 54, and 3.7 points below where it stood a decade earlier. Connection spread; the gap between who can use what the state provides did not close with it.

The division that is easiest to see on a map is geographic. Internet use and use of digital government services concentrate in the coastal belt running through Tunis, Sfax and Sousse, with the interior and rural governorates markedly less connected (2024). That is the same belt that holds the country's industry and its administration, so the connectivity line and the service line fall in the same place rather than cutting across each other.

Where people are connected, they are connected through the phone rather than the computer (2026), which sets what a digital service can assume about screen, storage and document handling at the other end. The headline mobile penetration figure overstates how far that reach goes, because it counts SIM connections rather than people, and multi-device and machine connections sit inside it.

Disability appears in the record mainly as an absence: the state's citizen feedback platforms offer no support for users with disabilities and no route to the same function through another channel (2025). The skills floor is the one line the state addresses directly, through digital skills programmes open to citizens and schools free of charge (2025) — a supply-side answer that leaves the device, channel and geography barriers above it untouched.

Access to services

Tunisia's tax portal was built without taxpayers involved in the design of its online services, and offers no route to the same transaction through another channel (2025) — a service designed without the people who use it, and with nothing behind it if the digital route fails. The national service portal is weaker still: it is informational rather than transactional, so citizens can find out about services on it but cannot complete most of them there.

The binding constraint is not connection. Most Tunisians were using the internet in 2026, and a mobile broadband basket sits inside the affordability band the ITU uses (2024). What stands between a connected person and a service is the credential and the counter, not the line.

The credential gates the services that matter most to the poorest. The national identity card is mandatory to enrol in the Amen Social programme and to collect any social protection payment, and public perception of how easy it is to obtain an identity document is among the most deteriorated of all the indicators the Ibrahim index tracks for Tunisia (2023) — a document getting harder to obtain in front of a benefit that cannot be drawn without it. The registration layer beneath it is sound: birth registration is effectively universal across rural and urban areas and both sexes, and civil registration is open to foreigners whose civil status events occur in the country.

Non-citizens are excluded a layer up rather than at the register. The unique citizen identifier is restricted by law to Tunisian nationals, with no provision for foreign residents, refugees or other non-citizens — so a resident foreigner can be registered by the state but cannot be identified by the system the state is building its services on.

At the payment end the digital route is still the minority one: part of Amen Social's cash transfers move through payment cards linked to electronic wallets, and the rest is still paid in cash (2024), against an access-to-banking score that is one of the country's ten worst-performing indicators (2023).

Technology

AI

Artificial intelligence has a large place in Tunisian planning and almost none in Tunisian law: Volume II of the Plan de développement 2026-2030, tabled in June 2026, names artificial intelligence 119 times and data 72 times. Behind the word there is no dedicated instrument. The 2021 National Digital Development Strategy is the single policy covering artificial intelligence, and covers nine other domains as well, from broadband and broadcasting to digital identification and e-commerce; the national strategy on disruptive and innovative technologies has not been adopted (2025); and in April 2026 the communication technologies minister was still pledging further legal and regulatory development on artificial intelligence.

Where parliament has taken up the subject, it has done so through data protection rather than through technology policy: the committee chair, Thabet Abed, framed the data protection bill against the growing influence of algorithms and surveillance technologies (February 2026).

In the state's own services, nothing is running. No chatbot or other AI-enabled technology is used to improve citizen engagement in Tunisian government services (2025). The compute such systems would need is at the same stage as the policy: the development plan carries data centres as a named project line alongside its artificial intelligence projects, and the only AI-specific facility on the record is a non-binding memorandum between SoleCrypt and Schneider Electric covering liquid-cooled, AI-dedicated data centres (February 2026). The plan also names artificial intelligence, data analysis, programming and cybersecurity as the skills base of the digital economy it makes a pillar of human-capital development.

Public use has moved ahead of all of this. Roughly half of Tunisian internet users report using AI applications, in the INT observatory's 2026 national survey on internet use and digital skills.

Reported use of AI applications runs well ahead of reported use of online public administration in that same survey (2026).

ICT Industry

Tunisia's technology sector is large relative to the economy and unmeasured by the state's own statistics: it accounts for around a tenth of GDP across more than two thousand firms, with much of technology employment held by people under 30 (2025), while the World Bank's statistical performance indicators record no business or establishment survey conducted in the decade to 2023.

The visible corporate layer is telecommunications, and it is a three-operator market. Tunisie Telecom, Orange Tunisia and Ooredoo Tunisia all launched commercial 5G within days of each other in February 2025, under licences awarded at the end of 2024, and Orange brought the Medusa submarine cable into commercial operation in June 2026.

Demand for what the sector sells is growing — electronic transaction values rose year on year in 2024 — but the shipping and postal layer that e-commerce delivery depends on has weakened over the decade to 2023, despite a high continental rank. Forming a company to sell into that demand can be started online through the public service portal (2025), and the labour the sector draws on includes a visible open-source developer community contributing publicly on GitHub.

Innovation ecosystem

Tunisia's innovation machinery is complete on paper and silent about its results. The government has a strategy, a running programme and an established innovation lab leading public sector innovation, together with a policy to support GovTech startups and private investment and state financing for startups and small and medium enterprises to innovate (2025). Yet neither the results of the public sector innovation programmes nor the innovation institution's annual performance is published, and nor are the results of the startup and SME support — which is also unaccompanied by any procurement policy giving startups or small firms preference in public bids, such as an SME quota (2025).

The legal frame is older than the machinery and narrower. The Startup Act of 2018 gives startups a dedicated legal framework, with a labelling procedure setting out the conditions and process for obtaining startup status; above it, no national strategy on disruptive and innovative technologies has been adopted (2025). Tunisia ranked 81st on WIPO's Global Innovation Index for 2024.

Private capital has kept arriving regardless. Tunisian startups continued to raise venture funding through 2024 and 2025, including rounds by the payments company Konnect from Renew Capital and Attijariwafa Ventures and a multi-million dollar round by the energy management company Wattnow. The physical side of the ecosystem is a network of dozens of technology and innovation hubs listed in AfriLabs' Tunisia directory, joined by an operator-run 5G lab at Berges du Lac in Tunis (February 2025). The Tunisia Digital Summit held its tenth edition in April 2026, drawing around 2,000 participants and 80 exhibitors, and announced Tunisia's first entry into the Startup World Cup.

Geopolitics

US / hyperscaler activities

No American public financing commitment, hyperscaler data-centre presence or bilateral digital agreement was in place in Tunisia as at August 2026.

China activities

No Chinese-financed digital infrastructure, network-equipment supply arrangement or bilateral digital agreement was in place in Tunisia as at August 2026.

EU activities

The European Union has claimed Tunisia's newest international connection as one of its own: it frames the Medusa cable's Bizerte landing as a Global Gateway project, and its ambassador to Tunisia, Giuseppe Perrone, attended the landing ceremony on 31 October 2025.

The money behind that landing is European twice over. The Tunisian segment and its landing station were built as the ViaTunisia project, part-funded by a Connecting Europe Facility Digital grant and coordinated by Orange Wholesale on an open-access model; the Commission's project record puts ownership and operation of the landing station and the Tunisian segment with Orange Tunisia rather than with the state incumbent, following the hosting agreement Orange Tunisia signed with Medusa in May 2023.

The larger European position is a lender's, and its terms are worth reading. The EBRD approved Project Hannibal, a senior development-linked loan to Tunisie Telecom, in July 2024, and it is the bank's first public-sector project in Tunisia to proceed without a sovereign guarantee — the credit risk sits with the operator, not with the Tunisian treasury. What makes that structure possible is European public money standing behind it: the loan is backed by a first-loss guarantee from the EU under the EFSD+ Digital Transformation window and complemented by an EU grant under the Neighbourhood Investment Platform, covering both investment and technical assistance. The Union absorbs the first losses on a loan another institution books and another party owes.

European institutions sit behind the state's internal plumbing as well. Tunisia's national data-exchange layer is an X-Road-based platform supplied by Estonia's Cybernetica, funded by the EBRD with Switzerland's SECO, whose first phase connecting five ministries and institutions ran to 2024; the second phase, extending it to business services with PwC as local partner and the same two funders, is scheduled to complete in 2027. Both the cable and the exchange layer therefore run on European finance and, in the exchange layer's case, on a European vendor's code.

India activities

No Indian financing commitment, India Stack-derived deployment or bilateral digital agreement was in place in Tunisia as at August 2026.

Gulf/UAE activities

Gulf capital entered Tunisia's licensed payments market in March 2026, when Ooredoo Fintech obtained a Central Bank of Tunisia licence for the walletii digital wallet, in partnership with QNB Group and the national payments operator Société Monétique Tunisie. Ooredoo and QNB are both Qatari, which places a Gulf-owned group inside the licensed payments perimeter alongside the state-linked operator that has run it.

The older Gulf position is in telecoms. Emirates International Telecommunications holds the minority stake in Tunisie Telecom alongside the state (July 2024), which makes an Emirati shareholder a party to the incumbent's European-financed network build rather than a competitor to it.

Capacity

Literacy

Tunisia gets almost every child through school and is steadily losing ground on what they learn there. The Mo Ibrahim Foundation's index puts education completion at 97.2 out of 100 for 2023, first of the 54 African states measured and 8.1 points higher than a decade before, with teacher supply second at 99.4. Over the same ten years the education quality measure fell 8.7 points to 56.2, tenth of 54, and public satisfaction with education provision fell further and faster, down 14.6 points to 33.5 and thirty-second of 54 (2023). Throughput is not the problem; the value of what is being got through is.

The digital layer sits on top of that. Primary schools, including in lagging regions, have been fitted with computer labs under a World Bank-supported programme, alongside a national school portal launched in 2024 for parents and teachers (2026).

What that schooling does not yet do is teach people to read a scam. When a phishing campaign went after users' banking details, the national cybersecurity agency's answer was advice: distrust unsolicited SMS and untrusted links, and check that a site sits on the national .tn domain, which it states Tunisian government websites use exclusively (July 2026). The test it hands the public is a naming convention, and the work of applying it falls on whoever receives the message.

Training and skills

The state trains and does not report: government digital skills programmes are offered to citizens and schools free of charge, while results and progress are recorded internally and not published (2025). Nobody outside the ministries running them can say whether they work, or how many people they have reached.

The direction is set on paper. The Plan de developpement 2026-2030 names artificial intelligence, data analysis, programming and cybersecurity as the skills base of a digital economy it makes a pillar of human-capital development, without attaching targets to any of them. Inside government there is a strategy for improving digital skills in the public service, pitched at basic skills.

The pipeline feeding all this is unusually strong for the region, resting on Tunisia's tertiary STEM and engineering base, and the technology employment that absorbs it skews young. The matching between the two runs through the state: Tunisia operates a job portal for registration, search and applications online, with a separate portal for public sector positions, reachable through several channels (2025).

Research institutions

Tunisia has one of the world's highest shares of tertiary graduates in STEM subjects, with tertiary completion rising from 22.8 to 29.6 per cent and long-established engineering and computing institutions behind it — Tunis El Manar, INSAT, ENIT and Sup'Com (2025). That is a base that produces knowledge rather than only importing it, and it is the country's strongest asset in this area.

It also turns on the country itself: Tunisian academic work on clinical record-keeping has examined how far the health system's own paperwork has actually been digitised, and found paper still dominant (2024).

Digitalisation

Rural digital data capture

Tunisia's rural policy and institutions rate first of 54 African states on the Ibrahim Index's rural economy measure, at 85.7 of 100 in 2023, up ten points over the decade to that year and the country's best-performing and fastest-improving sub-category. Rural market access scores 94.4, also first in Africa and up 15.8 points across the same decade, and rural representation and participation 84.1, fifth (2023).

What that rural economy does not do is produce data at the point it is generated. Rural civil status offices enter births, deaths and marriages on paper first and transcribe them into the national digital system afterwards (2021). Rural primary care clinics work from paper at the point of care, and in February 2025 the health ministry described connecting front-line primary facilities to the internet as a phase still to come rather than one already delivered. Justice-sector digitisation had not extended electronic case exchange to the police, the National Guard, customs or the prison administration (2020). Schools are the partial exception: a national school platform launched in 2024 consolidates school services for parents and teachers, and primary computer labs have been equipped in lagging regions under a World Bank-supported programme.

The binding constraint is not electricity. Access reaches effectively the whole population, with no material gap between urban and rural areas (2023). It is that internet use and access to digital government services concentrate in the coastal belt of Tunis, Sfax and Sousse, leaving the interior and rural governorates markedly less connected (2024) — and that where the capture happens, the paper register is still the record.

Digitalisation of sub-national government

The newest piece of digital machinery aimed below the national level is a national register of community companies, launched in July 2026 and run by the employment ministry as a registration and tracking platform to support local development.

Public finance is where the digital state does reach the local tier. A unified budget classification and chart of accounts covers both central and sub-national government, and the operational financial management information system, built on custom software, covers local as well as central government budgets (2025). The interoperability layer does not follow it down: the institutions participating in the national interoperability platform are all central-government ones (2024), so a municipality that wants a record held by another arm of the state is not fetching it through the exchange.

The registers a municipal administration would draw on are thinner still. Tunisia has no national address register: the postal service operates only a locality-level four-digit postcode system in place since 1980, and the cadastre records parcels rather than street names and building numbers.

Data

National statistics

Tunisia has the second-strongest statistical system in Africa and is slowly losing that ground: the Mo Ibrahim Foundation scored its capacity of the statistical system at 79.7 of 100 for 2023, 2nd of 54 African states but 4.2 points down over the preceding decade. The World Bank's pillar scores for the same year show where the weakness sits: Tunisia clears 89% on the use of data and holds the 70 to 89% band for statistical services and products, but falls to the 50 to 69% band for both data sources and data infrastructure. The state gets more out of its statistics than the machinery producing them would suggest it should.

The counting itself is largely done. A population census and a business census have been run within the past ten years, and an agricultural census within twenty. The survey programme has held up as well, with three or more labour force surveys, two household surveys, two health surveys and one agricultural survey over the decade to 2023 — and no business or establishment survey at all. The productive economy is therefore measured through the register rather than in the field, and that register counts formal firms against an informal sector large enough that they are far from the whole economy (2024).

Vital statistics rest on a civil register that digitises only births and deaths, leaving marriages and divorces legally registered but never entered into the digital system (2020), even so, population and vital statistics remain the best-covered category of Tunisia's published social data (2024). Where the state watches itself most closely is spending: the financial management information system captures expenditure tied to the Sustainable Development Goals extensively and holds non-financial performance indicators for most government programmes (2025).

Open data

Tunisian public records have become far easier to reach without becoming much easier to see into. Accessibility of public records rose 19.5 points over 2014 to 2023, reaching 59.6 of 100 and 4th of 54 African states, the fifth most improved of the index's 96 indicators; disclosure of public records gained 6.3 points over the same decade and still stands at 32.3 of 100, 30th of 54.

The right to ask is real in law. Tunisia's right-to-information legislation is assessed as effective, obliges public bodies to make information available online, and has a body monitoring its implementation (2025). What that monitoring finds — how many requests are received and granted — is recorded internally and not published (2025).

The open data portal carries a comprehensive catalogue and is refreshed weekly or daily, though updated mostly by hand rather than through APIs (2025). What reaches it is uneven. Open Data Watch's 2024 scoring of social statistics runs from 8 out of 10 for population and vital statistics down to 2.5 for crime and justice, with health outcomes and food security at 3; economic and financial data is tighter, from 7.5 for banking and monetary data and for prices to 5 for national accounts and the balance of payments; environmental data spans 7 for natural resources to 3.5 for pollution. The cadastre office runs a public geoportal for land and parcel data (2025).

Off the portal, the default is internal. The GovTech institution's annual report and the spending on digital transformation, the results of public sector innovation and digital skills programmes, the performance and user experience data of the public service portal, the Data Protection Authority's complaints record, and the audit trails of the customs, payroll, HR and e-procurement systems are all held and none released (2025). Procurement is the exception: Tunisia publishes its e-procurement data to the Open Contracting Data Standard. A government body responsible for data governance exists, housed inside another institution, and works without a data governance strategy behind it (2025). In February 2026 the Head of Government directed the administration to embed open data across the digitalisation programme.

Use of satellite data

No national space or geospatial data policy had been adopted in Tunisia as at August 2026.

Finance

New investments

The largest single commitment on record to Tunisia's digital estate is also the EBRD's first public-sector operation in the country to proceed without a sovereign guarantee. Under Project Hannibal the Bank approved on 24 July 2024 a senior development-linked loan of up to €190m to Tunisie Telecom, structured in four tranches with a first committed tranche of €50m, announced publicly on 16 January 2026. It is backed by a first-loss EU EFSD+ guarantee and complemented by an €11m EU grant under the Neighbourhood Investment Platform, and its first listed use of proceeds is the operator's connection to the Medusa submarine cable, alongside fibre roll-out and a mobile upgrade to 4G+ and 5G.

Three external commitments to the digital estate are on record, spanning project windows from 2016 to 2025 and worth together over USD 200 million on August 2026 conversions. The EBRD accounts for the overwhelming bulk, with the EU and the African Development Bank supplying the remainder. Connectivity takes almost all of it, leaving open data and statistics as the only other funded subsector; the single loan carries the money, and the two grants come to a few per cent of it. The EU grant covers exactly 30 per cent of the ViaTunisia budget, €9.6m of €32m.

The EU is co-funding the ViaTunisia landing infrastructure with €9.6m from the Connecting Europe Facility Digital programme against a €32m project budget, over a window running from March 2023 to August 2025. Older money is smaller and slower: the African Development Bank and the OECD mobilised a MENA Transition Fund grant of XDR 1,355,456 in 2016 for planning, statistics and monitoring, including a statistical dissemination infrastructure for open data, and less than half of it had been disbursed by the project's finalisation in 2023.

Three further undertakings carry no recorded value: the EBRD is funding the interoperability platform's second phase with Switzerland's SECO, for completion in 2027 (May 2026); a South Korean consortium led by Samsung C&T has been digitising the cadastre archives since May 2025; and World Bank financing agreed in 2026 is directed at a beneficiary registry and social-protection payments.

MoUs and other agreements

Tunisia's newest data-centre agreement binds nobody: SoleCrypt and Schneider Electric signed a non-binding memorandum of understanding in February 2026 covering AI-dedicated, low-water, liquid-cooled data centres built to Nvidia-co-developed reference architectures. The other signature on record commits to a place rather than to a sum: Orange Tunisia agreed on 11 May 2023 to host the Medusa submarine cable at Bizerte, signing with Medusa to develop the landing infrastructure and position northern Tunisia as a gateway between Europe and Africa.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

EDITION	**2026-08-18**
CURRENT EDITION	https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/reports/TUN/TUN-status.html
THIS FILE	https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/reports/TUN/TUN-status-2026-08-18.pdf
LICENCE	CC BY 4.0

Figures are dated because most are time-varying: a figure carries the date it was true, not the date you are reading it. Where the base holds no reliable statement, the document says **Not held** rather than leaving a silence — those are counted, and listed at the end.

This is a dated edition and is not revised after publication. If a figure here has moved, the current edition will say so.